

The Local Crafts: Complete Platform Manual

Welcome to **The Local Crafts** complete platform manual. This guide is broken down by user roles, covering everything from basic customer navigation to advanced system administration.

1. Customer Guide

The Customer role is the default experience designed for exploring heritage, purchasing crafts, and interacting with the artisan network.

1.1 Account Creation & Login

- **Sign Up:** Navigate to the /login page, select the **Customer** tab, and enter your email and a secure password. Click "Create an account" at the bottom if you are new.
- **Login:** Use the same **Customer** tab to sign in. Once signed in, your top navigation bar will provide a link to your **Customer Dashboard**.

1.2 Exploring the Platform

- **Craft Map & Regions:** Use the top navigation to explore interactive maps or filter by specific regions (e.g., Punjab, Sindh, KPK).
- **Global Search:** Click the Search icon in the header to instantly query specific crafts, materials, or regions (e.g., "Blue Pottery").

1.3 Purchasing (WhatsApp Checkout Flow)

1. Add items to your **Bag** by clicking the "Add to Cart" or "Buy Now" buttons on any product page.
2. Open your Cart using the Shopping Bag icon in the header.
3. Review your items and click **Checkout**.
4. Enter your shipping details (Name, Phone, Address, City). You can optionally add an "Impact Fund Tip" which goes directly to the artisan community.
5. Click **Confirm Order (WhatsApp)**. The platform automatically generates a detailed, pre-formatted order receipt and opens WhatsApp so you can send it directly to the platform's order management number.

1.4 Customer Dashboard

- Access your dashboard via the header button.
 - Here, you can view your **Order History** and track the status of items currently in fulfillment (Pending, Shipped, Delivered).
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2. Artisan Guide

The Artisan role is for verified creators looking to manage their global presence and sell products on the platform.

2.1 The Application Process

- **Apply:** Artisans must apply via the /apply page. They provide their Full Name, Specialty (e.g., Copperware), Bio, Location, and Contact Information.
- **Pending Status:** Upon submission, the artisan account is created with a pending status. Artisans *cannot* list products or view their dashboard until a System Administrator reviews and approves their heritage application.

2.2 Artisan Dashboard

Once approved, the artisan gains access to the /dashboard/artisan portal:

- **Crafts / Products:** Artisans can add new products to the marketplace. They specify the Title, Price, Description, Category (from the global registry), Stock limits, and upload product images.
- **Order Fulfillment:** When a customer purchases their specific product, it appears in their dashboard. The artisan prepares the item for dispatch.
- **Profile Management:** Artisans can update their public biography, location, and avatar, which is visible to customers on the /artisans network page.

3. Administrator Guide (System Core)

The System Administrator role provides unrestricted global access to the platform's data and operations.

[!WARNING]

Admin accounts cannot be created from the public sign-up page. To become an Admin, a database owner must manually change the user's role to admin directly inside the Firebase Console (profiles collection).

3.1 Accessing the Portal

Navigate to /login, select the **Administrator** tab, and sign in. Unauthorized users are blocked automatically.

3.2 System Core (Main Dashboard)

Your live operations center:

- **Global Pipeline:** Track total revenue, total orders, and network size.
- **Live Network Stream:** View a global feed of all recent transactions. You manage the fulfillment lifecycle here by updating order statuses (Pending -> Processing -> Shipped -> Delivered).

3.3 Heritage Categories

Manage the global "Registry" of craft types (e.g., Copperware, Blue Pottery, Textiles).

- **Append / Modify:** Add new categories, including the geographical origin, thumbnail images, and historical descriptions.
- **Note:** Products rely on these categories. Deleting a category may leave existing products "orphaned."

3.4 Identity Access (User Approvals)

The heart of the platform's security and quality control.

- **Pending Artisans:** Review applications from new artisans.
- Click **Approve** to grant them marketplace access, or **Reject** if they fail verification.

3.5 Wholesale Management

Manage B2B partnerships and affiliate operations.

- **Partner Applications:** Approve businesses applying via /apply/wholesale.
 - **Commission Register:** Automatically tracks and calculates 10% affiliate payouts owed to partners whose referral links generated successful sales.
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4. Wholesale / Partner Guide

The Wholesale role is for businesses, boutique owners, and curators who want to buy in bulk or act as affiliates.

4.1 Application

Businesses apply via the /apply/wholesale page, providing their Business Name and intended volume. Similar to Artisans, they remain pending until Admin approval.

4.2 Partner Dashboard

- **B2B Sourcing:** Access wholesale catalogs and bulk pricing.
- **Affiliate Links:** Partners can generate unique tracking links. When a customer uses this link to make a purchase, the partner automatically earns a commission, which is tracked via their dashboard.